1.4 Growth of world population

After the introduction of agriculture about 8,000 to 12,000 years ago, the size of population was small, roughly 8 million. In the first century (C.E) it was below 300 million. The expanding world trade during the sixteenth and seventeenth century, set the stage for rapid population growth. Around 1750, at the dawn of Industrial Revolution, the world population was 550 million. World population exploded in the eighteenth century after the Industrial Revolution. Technological advancement achieved so far helped in the reduction of birth rate and provided a stage for accelerated population growth.

The current **world population of 7.6 billion** is expected to reach 8.6 billion in 2030, 9.7 billion in 2050 and 11.2 billion in 2100, according to a new United Nations report being launched. With roughly **83 million people being added to the world's population every year**, the upward trend in population size is expected to continue, even assuming that fertility levels will continue to decline.

The current world population, according to UN Department of Economic and Social Affairs, Feb, 2019, is 7,685,036,620.

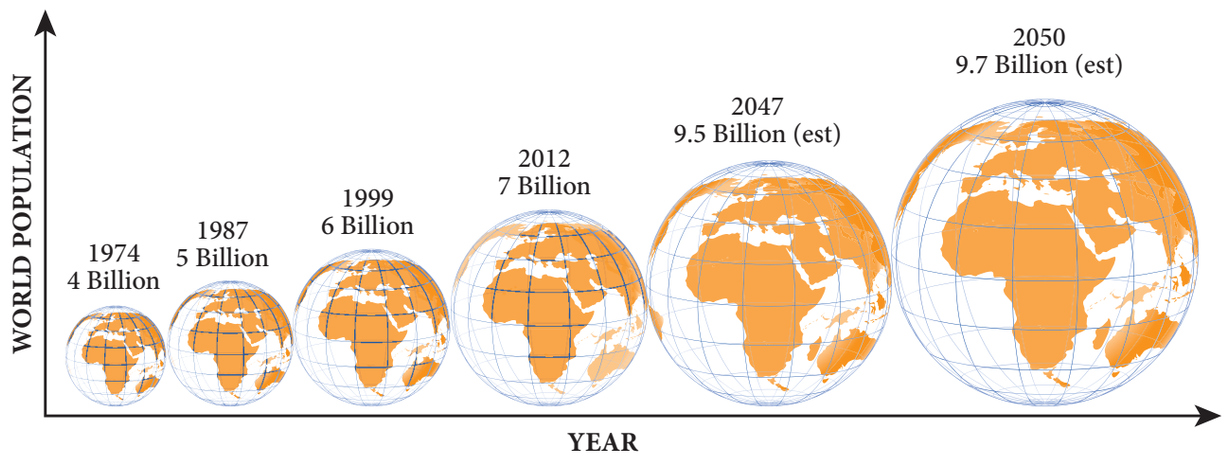
The new projections include some notable findings at the country level. **China (with 1.4 billion inhabitants) and India (1.3 billion inhabitants) remain the two most populous countries, comprising 19% and 18% of the total global population respectively.** In roughly seven years, or around 2024, the population of India is expected to surpass that of China.

Among the ten largest countries worldwide, **Nigeria** is growing the most rapidly. Consequently, the population of Nigeria, currently the world's 7th largest, is projected to surpass that of the United States and become the third largest country in the world shortly before 2050.

Most of the global increase is attributable to a small number of countries.

From 2017 to 2050, it is expected that half of the world's population growth will be concentrated in just nine countries: India, Nigeria, Congo, Pakistan, Ethiopia, the United Republic of Tanzania, the United States of America, Uganda and Indonesia (ordered by their expected contribution to total growth).

The group of 47 least developed countries (LDCs) continues to have a relatively high level of fertility, which stood at 4.3 births per woman in 2010-2015. As a result, the population of these countries has been growing rapidly, at around 2.4 % per year. Although this rate of increase is expected to slow significantly over the coming decades, the combined population of the LDCs,



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